



Nexus 10 launched in Japan

Google and Samsung's Nexus 10 tablet was finally launched in Japan after two and a half months of the original launch

Google Now Updated

Google Now app for Android 4.1 Jelly Bean has now been updated with new widgets and improved functionality

Smartphones Test

of the three when it comes to its underlying hardware but if you will use the device for everyday activities, you won't notice any performance difference as the WP7.5 OS is optimized to run smoothly on the most basic hardware. The Micromax Canvas 2 A110 and the A116 Canvas HD are very similar in their appearance as well as their UI skin. You may not be able to tell the devices apart if you didn't know which was which simply by looking at the interface. The Canvas HD however feels smoother and even has a better display. It feels like the next-gen version of an already successful product. Videos ran very smoothly on the device and apps loaded in an instant. The camera too is good especially in low light conditions. The downside is that the camera requires you to hold the device very still, as it lacks image stabilization.

The Spice Stellar Virtuoso Mi-495 has a very simple skin that's nice to use. The viewing angles on the display aren't the best but the camera on the Virtuoso is a lot better than what we've experienced on other devices. The call quality from the device is good, but it does suffer from lag when subjected to heavy multitasking.

The Karbonn A30 is the largest phone on our list and the features don't do justice to the phone's overall size. Its display resolution is really low making multimedia content look really pixelated. The icons may be large and typing text messages may appeal to those who need a big display, but the device is plagued with lag and a general lacklustre feel because of the display. Its benchmark score too feels a bit of a let-down when compared to other devices in this shootout. At first glance, the Lava Xolo A800

appears like your run of the mill Android device. The skin is very minimalistic and the viewing angles of its display are good. In general usage, the device is smoother than we expected. Don't judge a book by its cover really applies to this device as it may look really simple, but it is a treat to use.

The HTC desire C can be considered more as a toy than a smartphone. The power under the hood isn't the best, yet the interface feels smooth. You will see the device lag if you use some of the heavier apps and consume multimedia content on it isn't the best because of how small it is. Where it does work well is as a simple phone to make calls and texting. The keyboard though small feels well laid out.

The iBall Andi 4.5h and the 4.5q are identical in their interface. The 4.5h has better viewing angles but the black levels are far better on the 4.5q's display. Both the devices do take a heart-beat longer to launch apps and open menus than we'd like. The 4.5q feels better thanks to the Jelly Bean OS but the 4.5h has more RAM, which shines during multitasking.

The Micromax A90S has the best display in this range. It is fantastic for watching video and playing games. Its form factor is very comfortable for texting and everyday phone use. The skin on the device may be too childish for some, but it does remind us a lot of the 2008 Prince of Persia game. The only downside is the phone's battery won't last the entire day if you push the device to its limits.

The Spice Stellar Pinnacle Mi-530 can be your budget phablet. The viewing angles of the device aren't the best and the interface skin makes it lag a lot, but the device is very good for typing long messages



Spice-Pinnacle-Mi-530

and emails. The camera however requires you to keep your hand quite stable. The capacitive buttons on the device are represented with dots and may take some time getting used to.

SMARTPHONES FROM ₹15,001 TO ₹20,000

These devices usually boast of good power under the hood along with great looks and some unique features not as prevalent among lower-priced smartphones. The devices here may not be the flagship devices of their respective manufacturers but they do have enough juice to satisfy the consumer looking for a device that isn't quite budget-conscious but isn't priced sky high either.

Design

The One V does have a design advantage over most of its rivals – it sports a touch of aluminium over the traditional and popular

plastic finish. The unibody design just adds that extra bit of solidity to the entire package but makes the battery inaccessible which is a disadvantage. It also looks like the HTC Legend's twin brother. The position of the camera is a poor choice as it is easy to cover the camera with your finger when shooting in landscape mode.

The HTC Desire X has a very curvy design, and feels slimmer than it is in one's hands. The device is surprisingly comfortable to hold for both single as well as dual hand use. The rear of the device has a pearl white finish with a metal strip around the camera. Again the location of the camera is inconvenient for shooting in portrait mode.

The LG Optimus L9 has a very simple rectangular design with slightly sharp edges, something we have seen with the LG Optimus 4X HD. The rear has a textured plastic finish, which feels slightly cheap. The home